

M & M Engineering & Consultancy

COMPANY PROFILE

M & M Engineering & Consultancy

About Us

M & M Engineering & Consultancy CC is a leading engineering consultancy and construction firm specializing in providing innovative and sustainable solutions to clients across various industries. With over 10 years of experience, our team of experts has successfully completed a wide range of projects, from small-scale renovations to large-scale commercial developments.

Our engineering consultancy services cover a broad spectrum of disciplines, including civil, structural, mechanical, electrical, and environmental engineering. Our team of highly skilled engineers uses the latest tools and technologies to develop innovative solutions that meet our clients' unique needs. We have experience working on a variety of projects, including infrastructure development, building construction, industrial facilities, and transportation systems.

In addition to our engineering consultancy services, we offer comprehensive construction services to our clients. We have a proven track record of delivering projects on time and within budget while maintaining the highest standards of quality and safety. Our construction services cover all phases of the project, from design and planning to construction and project management.

At M & M Engineering & Consultancy, we are committed to providing our clients with exceptional service and building lasting relationships based on trust, reliability, and professionalism. We work closely with our clients to understand their needs and deliver solutions that exceed their expectations. Contact us today to learn more about how we can help you with your next project.

Vision

To provide engineering ingenuity and technical services

Mission

To be the most sort after provider for engineering and technical services for Namibia.

Details

Registration identification number: CC/2013/6661,

Tax identification number: 6140420-01-1

BANK ACCOUNT: FIRST NATIONAL BANK, NAMIBIA

BANK ACCOUNT NUMBER: 62266917643.

BRACH CODE: 282672



M & M Engineering & Consultancy

Our Merits

Unique and creative solutions that meet the clients' expectations not only by realizing the clients' business objectives, but particularly by our strict adherence to the ethical principles of Engineering, Technology and Construction.

Continuous search for opportunities beyond the agreed engineering, technology and construction business objectives.

Creative approaches to the clients' special needs in order to find unique and tailored engineering, technology and construction solutions.

Team work based on the implementation of progressive engineering, technology and construction disciplines.

Professional quality of services provided by a highly motivated team Courage and readiness to communicate on behalf of client in crisis Strong technological background.

24/7 availability.

Services

- Electrical Engineering services
- Civil Engineering Services
- Telecommunications Engineering Services
- Mining Engineering Services
- Information Technology Systems & Services
- Energy Services (Electrical/Solar/ Hydrogen) Designs and Construction
- Mechanical Engineering
- Road Construction
- Geological Services
- Building Civils and Construction
- Architectural Services
- Project Management
- Railway infrastructure design and services



M & M Engineering & Consultancy

Construction

M & M offers a wide range of construction services to our clients, including:

- Design and planning: Our team of experienced architects, engineers, and designers work collaboratively to develop innovative and cost-effective designs that meet our clients' needs. We use the latest design software and technology to create 3D models and renderings that allow our clients to visualize their project before construction begins.

- Construction management: Our team of project managers oversees all aspects of the construction process, from scheduling and budgeting to quality control and safety. We work closely with our clients and subcontractors to ensure that the project is completed on time, within budget, and to the highest standards of quality.

- General contracting: We provide general contracting services for all types of construction projects, from small-scale renovations to large-scale commercial developments. Our team of experienced contractors has the skills and expertise to manage every aspect of the construction process, from site preparation and excavation to finishing and interior design.

- Site preparation: Our site preparation services include excavation, grading, and site clearing. We use state-of-the-art equipment and techniques to prepare the site for construction, ensuring that it is safe and ready for building.

- Building construction: We specialize in building construction, including commercial, industrial, and residential buildings. Our team of skilled tradespeople and subcontractors has the expertise to handle all aspects of the construction process, from foundation and framing to finishing and interior design.

- Renovations and remodeling: We provide renovation and remodeling services for all types of buildings, including commercial and residential properties. We work closely with our clients to understand their needs and develop customized solutions that meet their requirements and budget.

- At M & M, we are committed to delivering exceptional construction services that exceed our clients' expectations.

Strategic Engineering, Technology and Construction Consulting

Strategic consulting in engineering, technology and construction as understood by M & M focuses on the ability to identify and exploit communication opportunities.

Utilizing the identified engineering, technology and construction opportunities helps our clients forge existing and build new relationships with their customers and/or suppliers.

M & M provides strategic engineering, technology and construction consulting a number of organisations.

Among strategic consulting services, M & M provides:

- Tendering
- Project Management Effectiveness and Evaluation
- Identifying engineering, technology and construction Opportunities.



M & M Engineering & Consultancy

Electrical and Instrumentation:

- Supply and erection of major electrical equipment.
- Power distribution systems
- Lighting and power
- Fire detection and alarm systems
- Programmable logic control systems (PLC)
- SCADA systems
- Structural cabling
- Security systems
- Instrumentation and control works
- Telecommunication systems

Mechanical Works:

- Supply, fabrication and erection of major process static equipment
- Process piping and Pipelines
- Fire fighting systems
- Pipe gantry's and support systems
- Cranes
- Supply and erection of rotary equipment
- HVAC systems
- Insulation, Painting and scaffolding works

Highways, Roads and Infrastructure:

- Highways and roads.
- Underpasses, bridges and interchanges.
- Major earth and reclamation works.
- Turnkey Infrastructure Projects.
- Site development works for industrial and petrochemical plants.
- Pipeline construction (water, sewage and drainage).
- Treated sewage effluent system (TSE).
- Drainage and sewage systems.
- Electrical and telecommunication networks.
- Street lighting.
- Signalization and traffic light systems.
- Tunneling including related electrical and mechanical works.

Civil Works:

- Underground and elevated concrete structures
- Silos
- Cooling towers
- Precast concrete Pipe racks
- Culverts
- Structural Steel Works
- Industrial buildings
- Underground utility networks
- Road works
- Fencing
- Enabling works
- Concrete works
- Curtain wall systems
- Stone cladding
- Steel structure
- Architectural finishes.



M & M Engineering & Consultancy

Our Engineering Consultancy Service

M & M Engineering & Consultancy offers a range of engineering consultancy services to clients across various industries, including:

Civil Engineering: Our civil engineering services include site planning and development, transportation infrastructure design, water and wastewater treatment, and storm water management. We use the latest software and technology to develop innovative solutions that meet our clients' needs and are environmentally sustainable.

Structural Engineering: Our structural engineering services cover all types of structures, including buildings, bridges, and industrial facilities. We use advanced analysis tools and techniques to design safe and reliable structures that can withstand extreme weather conditions and other hazards.

Mechanical Engineering: Our mechanical engineering services cover all aspects of mechanical systems, including HVAC, plumbing, and fire protection. We use energy-efficient design strategies to reduce operating costs and ensure that the systems we design are reliable and easy to maintain.

Electrical Engineering: Our electrical engineering services cover all aspects of electrical systems, including power distribution, lighting, and communication systems. We use the latest technologies and design tools to develop electrical systems that are safe, reliable, and efficient.

Environmental Engineering: Our environmental engineering services include environmental impact assessments, environmental remediation, and sustainable development. We work closely with our clients to develop solutions that minimize the environmental impact of their projects and comply with local regulations and standards.

Project Management: Our project management services cover all phases of the project, from planning and design to construction and commissioning. We use proven project management methodologies and tools to ensure that projects are delivered on time, within budget, and to the highest standards of quality.



M & M Engineering & Consultancy

Track Record

M & M Engineering & Consultancy has executed a variety of jobs across multiple industries, including:

1. Infrastructure development: We have worked on numerous infrastructure development projects, including highways, bridges, airports, and water treatment plants. Our team of engineers, architects, and project managers has the expertise to manage complex infrastructure projects from start to finish.
2. Building construction: We have completed several building construction projects, including commercial and residential buildings. Our team of skilled tradespeople and subcontractors has the expertise to manage all aspects of the construction process, from site preparation and excavation to finishing and interior design.
3. Industrial facilities: We have experience in designing and building industrial facilities such as warehouses, factories, and manufacturing plants. Our team of experts understands the unique needs of the industrial sector and has the knowledge and experience to deliver innovative solutions that meet our clients' requirements.
4. Transportation systems: We have worked on various transportation system projects, including light rail, subway, and bus rapid transit systems. Our team of transportation engineers and planners has the expertise to manage transportation projects from planning and design to construction and commissioning.
5. Environmental projects: We have completed several environmental projects, including environmental impact assessments, remediation, and sustainable development. Our team of environmental engineers and scientists has the expertise to develop and implement solutions that minimize environmental impact and promote sustainable development.

	Project Name	Principal Employer	Project Consultants	Contact	Project Value	Project Duration
1	Divundu Correctional Facility Hospital and Programme Areas Principal	Ministry of Safety and Security & Ministry of Works Project	Barnard Mutua Architects	Comm E. Ngolo +264 811 685140	N$13,000,000.00	18 Months
2	Nyae Nyae Police Station and Barracks	Ministry of Safety and Security & Ministry of Works	Kondjeni Kandji Architects	Wallace Bester +264 81 2603450	N$43,000,000.00	24 Months
3	NAMCOL Centre Rundu Phase 2	Namcol	Kenny Mcnamara Architects	Kelvin McNamara	N$ 8 000 000.00	9months
4	UNAM Clinic Main Campus	UNAM	Agustono Ferreira Architects	Jeremy Sholtz	N$ 8 000 000.00	12 Months
5	Ongwediva Social Housing phase II Centre on Erf 4797	Ongwediva Town Council	AIJ Consulting	Mr. S Mieze +264 65- 231434	N$ 3 400 000.00	12 Months
6	Construction of Electrical Services (Ekuku Township Phase 2)	Oshakati Town Council	Consulting Services Africa	Mr. Sam Amukwiyu Tel: 065 230316 Fax: 065 230317	N$ 13 608 000.00	8 Months
7	Electrical Services at Kaisosi Rundu NHE Phase 1.	Rundu Town Council	AIJ Consulting	Mr. Jorik. Email: jbqs@mweb.com.na	N$ 11 000 000.00	12 Months



8	Low Voltage Electrical Reticulation (Omusati Regional HQ)	Ministry of Agriculture Water & Forestry.	WML Consulting Engineers	Mr. Ronald Gerdes 061 220285	N$ 2 900 000.00	
9	New Electrical Reticulation of the Nukwa Military base in Zambezi region	Ministry of Defense	V Fischer-Buder Consulting Engineers	MR. V Fischer Buder 061 228 502	N$ 2 668 235.00	12 Months
10	Renovation of staff houses at Verda Gate Kunene Region	Ministry of Agriculture Water & Forestry (Directorate of Veterinary)	Ministry of Agriculture Water & Forestry	Mr. Simbundu Tel: 061-2087476	N$ 2 970 450.00	12 Months
11	Alteration & Additions to Rundu Hospital	Ministry of Health	RFPQS	Mr. Henk Louw 061 223991	N$ 2 700 000.00	6 Months
12	Construction of 63 Houses at Kaisosi Rundu NHE Phase I	Rundu Town Council	AIJ Project Cost Consultant	Mr. Jorik jbqs@mweb.com.na	N$ 19 445 350.00	24 Months
13	Electrical Installation at Omulunga community Market Onayena	Ministry of Trade and Industry	Conselect Engineering	Mr. Alexandre Frederico Tel: 061-309035	N$1 101 707.49	
14	Electrical Installation	Ministry of Education (Rundu Vocational Training Centre)	Emcon Consulting Engineers	Mr. Peter-John Christiane Tel: 061-224725	N$4 183 637.10	
15	Replacing of Electrical faulty cable and Installation of new Generator at Okakarara District Hospital in the Otjozondjupa Region	Replacing of Electrical faulty cable and Installation of new Generator at Okakarara District Hospital in the Otjozondjupa Region	Main Contractor: Tangi Trading Enterprise cc	Ms. Saima Hawala Tel: 061-241622	N$1 045 713.53	
16	MVA Ongwediva Phase II Electrical installation	MVA	Jacobs Engineering Consulting cc	Tichaona Chinyama Tel: 061-375459 Fax: 061-375454	N$603,346.35	
17	Construction and Electrical installation of Nkurenkuru Police Station	Ministry of Safety and Security - Nampol	Robert Lock Architect	Tel: 061-223127	N$4 000.000.00	
18	New Sub – Regional office Nkurenkuru Electrical Installation	Ministry of Safety & Security: Nampol	EMCON	Mr. Barnabas Mukaru Tel: 061-224725	N$310 514.95	



19	Omulunga Community Market (Onayena – oshikoto region)	Namibia Development Corporation	Conselect Engineering	Alexandre Frederico Tel: 061 – 309035	N$890,000.00	
20	Alterations and Additions to Rundu Hospital Accommodation Block Phase 2	Ministry of Health and Social Services	Richard Frankle & Partners	R.H.Frankle Tel: 061-223991	N$1 621 642.60	
21	Supply, Installation and Commissioning of the Air Conditioning & Ventilation	Namcol	Conselect Engineering	Mr Knowledge 065 230140	N$495 543.51	
22	Supply, installation, repair and servicing of Air conditioners At Tsumeb District Hospital	Ministry of Health and Social Services	Ministry of Health		N$ 187 714.50	
23	Simanya completion of Accommodation facilities and charge office at Nampol Base, Roads, paved parking areas and Walkways	Ministry of Safety and Security	Aurecon COnsultancy	Mr. Blanché Hanstein Tel: 061-2977066	N$ 4 843162.03	
24	Alterations additions to the existing Okahandja Hospital	Ministry of Health and Safety	Richard Frankle and Partners	Mr. T. Mbeeli Tel: 061-223991 Fax: 061-221130	N$1 908 784.31	
25	Ongenga Business Estate (Ohangwena region)	Namibia Development Corporation	Conselect Engineering	Alexander Frederico Tel: 061 – 309035	N$885,000.00	



Contact Details



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GENERAL INTRODUCTION TO MANUAL

INTRODUCTION

Standards of health and safety in the working environment have increased significantly during the past few decades. The advances of science and medical knowledge have brought about a major improvement in working conditions and methods. Health and Safety legislation has played a major part in this. Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992 "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work" places a duty on employers to publish a Health and Safety policy that details the organizational structure and arrangements for ensuring that adequate safety standards are maintained. The following is a full list of associated regulations/legislation pertaining to Occupational Health & Safety in Namibia:

- The Constitution of the Republic of Namibia
- Labour Act 2007 (Act no. 11, 2007
- Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work"
- Presidential Proclamation No. 10 Labour Act, 1992 Part XI, Section 101 of the Labour Act 1992)

DISTRIBUTION AND UPDATING OF POLICY.

It is a legal requirement that the Health and Safety policy is brought to the attention of employees. To facilitate this, the policy statement will be placed on the Health and Safety notice board. As changes occur the health and safety manual will be updated, and senior management will be sent a summary sheet by email notifying them of the changes.

HEALTH & SAFETY POLICY STATEMENT AND POLICY PROCEDURES

INTRODUCTION

This health and safety policy statement sets out how the company manages health and safety in our organization. It is unique document that shows who does what, and when and how they do it.

The Company is committed to complying with Namibian Legislation, and ensuring the health, safety, and welfare of all our employees, contractors, visitors, and all stakeholders. All staff members must familiarize themselves with this policy and sign to show that they read and understood fully the Company Occupational Health & Safety Policy.

LEGISLATION PERTAINING TO OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH & SAFETY

- The Constitution of the Republic of Namibia
- Labour Act 2007 (Act no. 11, 2007
- Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work" and
- Presidential Proclamation No. 10 Labour Act, 1992 Part XI, Section 101 of the Labour Act 1992)

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OUR STATEMENT OF GENERAL POLICY IS

- To provide adequate control of the health and safety risks arising out of work activities.
- To consult with our employees on matters affecting their health and safety.
- To provide and maintain safe plant and equipment.
- To ensure safe handling and use of substances.
- To provide information, instruction, and supervision for employees.
- To ensure all employees are competent to do their tasks, and to give them adequate training.
- To prevent accidents and cases of work-related ill health.
- To maintain safe and health working conditions and
- To review and revise this policy as necessary at regular intervals.

HEALTH & SAFETY POLICY:

ORGANISATIONAL LINES OF RESPONSIBILITY

Overall responsibility for the health and safety of all persons within the company rests with the Directors. The Managing Director/Chief Executive delegates this responsibility to the individual Safety Officer (See Appendix 1) for the purposes of the day to day running of the operation with the direct assistance of individual line managers and supervisors. This Company has a nominated safety officer who has overall company responsibility for reviewing and making recommendations on all matters relating to health and safety.

The safety officer will ensure through the management organization that:

- All persons employed by the company receive adequate health and safety training. In addition, employees will receive adequate instruction and supervision to enable them to undertake their work in a safe manner.
- All plant and equipment are suitable for their intended purpose and that it is always maintained in a safe condition.
- All persons working on company premises whether employees or not of the company are adequately notified of all known hazards and protective measures.
- That the company risk assessments, along with all other safety documentation, are brought to the attention of all relevant parties.
- All employees are required to comply with their legal requirements under current National statutory provisions. All staff must co-operate with the management of the company to allow it to comply with the legal requirements for health and safety and
- Individual members of staff, who have any concern regarding their own safety, or that of third party, are responsible for reporting the matter to their manager without delay.

All members of staff will receive a copy of this safety policy and will be required to sign to state that they have read and understood it. New members of staff will be required to read and sign a copy of this safety policy before they start work and their manager will familiarize, explain, and assist them to begin work in safe manner.

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FIRE SAFETY

The company will provide the necessary firefighting equipment in accordance with the requirements of National Standards and (Chapter 3 – Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992 "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work"). It is the policy of the Company to over rather than under provide such facilities. All employees are required to familiarize themselves with the fire drill before commencing work. Exercise will be arranged at regular intervals. Existing firefighting equipment will be inspected by a supervisor appointed by the safety officer on a weekly basis and by the external contract engineers on an annual basis. Alarms will be tested weekly. Firefighting equipment will be inspected, and a certificate issued by a competent authority on an annual basis.

- Fire exits must be always kept clear.
- No fire door to or from an occupied room may be locked. Smoking is only permitted in designated areas.
- No doors are to be wedged or propped open in any way.
- All personnel will be trained by their safety supervisor in the safe use of firefighting equipment;
- You should know which extinguishers are available in your immediate place of work. In particular you should ensure that combustible materials do not accumulate around your place of work.
- Flammable materials must never be exposed to hot surfaces or direct heat sources;
- In the event of a gas leak switch off all equipment and evacuate the premises immediate. Contact the Emergency Services immediately.
- In the event of a fire the premises should be evacuated immediately following the information provided on the fire notices.
- Fire extinguishers should only be removed from their wall brackets in an emergency; and
- The removal of fire extinguishers in other cases without good reason will be considered as misconduct.

NOTE: Please refer to the Company Fire Safety Logbook for further instructions.

ELECTRICAL SAFETY

Ensure that all electrical equipment you use is in good order in accordance with National standards and (Chapter 9 – Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work"). Do not use any electrical equipment that does not appear to be in good order but report it to your supervisor without delay. Changes to the electrical system (including new plugs) should only be undertaken by competent persons who have been trained and all works required should be reported to the safety officer. Work on electrical systems or live plant must be never be undertaken by unqualified personnel and live working requires a specific risk assessment to be undertaken.

General Safety Requirements for Electrical Systems

- Switch off all electrical equipment after use. Do not overload sockets.
- Do not allow wires to project into the walkways where they present a tripping hazard; and
- Use a residual circuit breaker when operating a portable hand tool.

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FIRST AID

The company will provide first aid facility in accordance with the requirements current National standards and (Chapter 7 – Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work"). The nominated first aiders will be published on the notice board. If you suffer an injury, however slight, report it to your manager and the nominated first aider at once. The injury must be entered in the accident book and you will be required to provide a full explanation of the events surrounding the accident.

If a serious accident occurs the first aider should be contacted at once. The first aider will arrange for an ambulance to be summoned immediately. If chemicals come into contact with your skin or eyes or if they are swallowed or inhaled, then seek immediate first aid. Your supervisor will have access to the company assessments within this manual which provide detailed advice on the measures to be taken to counteract the effects of each chemical used by the company.

NOTE: Please refer to the Company First Aid Logbook for further instructions.

TRAINING

The company will provide Occupational Health and Safety training in accordance with the requirements of current National standards and (Chapter 1 – Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work"). General induction training will be provided for all new members of staff. Additional training will be provided for nominated members of staff as required. The planning of training in health safety is the responsibility of the safety officer. Documented training records will be maintained. If any member of staff feels that he/she could benefit from specific safety training in addition to that which has been assessed as relevant by the company then they should approach their supervisor.

CLEANLINESS

Good housekeeping in all areas is an essential feature of safety and the prevention of accidents. Staff working in all areas must have regard to the following:

- Ensure that loose and worn flooring is reported to your supervisor;
- Ensure all entrances, corridors, walkways and exit doors are always kept clear of obstructions.
- Close all cabinets, cupboards, and drawers after use.
- Never overload shelving or store heavy items above head height except on load bearing purpose-built racking.
- Never leave alit cigarette unattended in the designated smoking area.
- Clear away immediately any dangerous substance or spillage. Dangerous substances are marked and are defined as toxic, harmful, irritant, flammable, or oxidizing.
- Dust and fumes should not be inhaled. If dust or fumes are produced by any activity, then cease and task immediately until protective measures have been put into place; and
- Equipment must not be left where it can be a tripping hazard.

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MANUAL HANDLING

Lifting and moving loads by hand are the biggest cause of injury in the workplace, lifting should be carried out in accordance with the following guidelines:

- If a load is awkward or beyond your capability you must get help.
- Check all packaging and articles for sharp edges and projections before lifting.
- Ensure that there are no obstructions in your path before lifting any article.
- Ensure that you can see around a load when lifting it.
- Ensure that there is adequate room to put down a load when you moved it.
- When lifting, stand close to the load with your feet slightly apart. Keep your chin in, bend your knees and always keep your back straight. Straighten your knees using your thigh muscles. Always lift in stages (e.g. floor to knee, knee to carrying position); and
- Always use your entire body weight in a controlled manner when pushing a load.

Heavy goods are to be lifted in accordance with the Company assessments for manual handling. Do not use lifting equipment unless you have been specifically authorized.

CONTROL OF HAZARDOUS SUBSTANCES

The law: (Chapter 5 – Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992 "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work") requires the company to control the use, disposal, and transportation of all hazardous materials. A formal assessment has been carried out of all materials used by the company and this is always available on site for reference purposes. Employees are not permitted to purchase or to bring to work substances which are not included on the chemical safety register. If a formal assessment has not been made, then that product may not be brought onto site.

Disposal of chemical products must only be carried out on the direct instruction of the safety officer. It is a strict requirement of the company that when any person handles a chemical, they never mix it with any other chemical product. The mixing of chemicals can lead to harmful chemicals being formed inadvertently.

PROTECTIVE CLOTHING

Where protective clothing is provided it must be worn. It is a strict legal offence for an employee to abuse or disregard safety equipment (Chapter 6 Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work"). You are obliged to use all personal protective equipment which has been provided following a detailed assessment. One of the major causes of injury in the workplace is a cut to the hand. Personal protective clothing in the form of gloves is a significant method of protection from such injuries. Gloves should always be worn when handling sharp items and when moving loads. Persons wishing to handle chemicals must first read the material assessment to determine the precise nature of the clothing required for any product.

VISUAL DISPLAY EQUIPMENT

The company will carry out formal assessment of all workstations where visual display screen equipment is used. It is the policy of the company to provide eye tests for visual display screen work where an employee is required to work with this equipment.

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MACHINERY

Only trained personnel may use machinery provided in the workplace in accordance with national standards (Chapter 4 – Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work"). If you have not received training, then under no circumstances should you attempt to operate it.

Prior to authorization being given to operate machinery an assessment of your competence will be carried out. If at any stage whilst using any item of machinery you begin to feel unwell you must stop what you are doing, isolate the plant concerned via the remote electrical supply switch and report to your supervisor.

Never talk to another member of staff when you are operating machinery. Do not approach or distract any other employee operating machinery.

GUARDING

It is not only dangerous but also illegal (Chapter 4 – Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work") to remove a guard from a machine unless you need to clean or repair it. Only trained personnel may clean or repair items or plant which requires guarding to be removed. Equipment which is to be cleaned must be isolated electrically. The electrical supply should be locked out and a notice should be fixed to the switch point advising that re-connection of the supply can be hazardous.

If any part of the equipment you are using is unguarded you should stop work immediately, isolate the plant concerned, and report the matter to the safety officer without delay.

VISITORS AND CONTRACTORS

All visitors and contractors must report to the main reception. Any contractor carrying out work at the premises may be required to provide the following details to the safety officer in advance of the work commencing:

- Health and Safety Policy
- Risk Assessments
- Chemical Safety Assessments
- Liability Insurance Cover.

Contractors carrying out electrical, gas or hot works will be issued with a permit to work before commencing work. A permit to work will also be required for persons working at height or in confined spaces. All contractors working for the company are required to comply with this safety policy and with all other written safety instructions.

RISK ASSESSMENTS

The company has produced detailed written risk assessments for all members of staff. All staff is required to read the Corporation risk assessments and always abide by their requirements.

IF AT ANY TIME YOU ARE CONCERNED BY ANY ASPECT OF SAFETY IN THE WORKPLACE THEN STOP WORK AND MAKE IMMEDIATE CONTACT WITH THE SAFETY OFFICER. IF YOU CANNOT CONTACT THE SAFETY OFFICER THEN MAKE CONTACT WITH YOUR SUPERVISOR.

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SAFETY MANAGEMENT

INTRODUCTION

Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work" has far reaching implications for the management of health and safety in all Company establishments and areas of service delivery and require that a thorough and modern system of safety management be adopted. The following summary provides relevant details and guidance on how the regulations should be implemented.

HEALTH AND SAFETY ARRANGEMENTS

The law requires that a written description be prepared detailing the arrangements for a structured scheme of safety management within the establishment, designed to achieve a progressive improvement in standards and performance. The aim of this is to create an effective '**safety culture'** in which the commitment to health and safety is adopted at all levels and where all share a common goal of constantly improving the management of risk.

This modern philosophy of 'risk management' has been adopted by the company, not only for the potential benefits:

The four key areas are:

- Planning
- Organization
- Control
- Monitoring and review

PLANNING

On at least an annual basis, it is necessary that management teams identify prioritize all their safety needs and objectives so that the necessary funding can be included in the budget plan and any necessary systems or procedures may be installed.

To ensure success, it is essential that the relevant members of staff be kept well informed and receive appropriate training about the identified standards and performance objectives and be given every encouragement to adopt them.

ORGANISATION

The effective management of health and safety requires the clear assignment of appropriate tasks and levels of responsibility to those designated to manage aspects of health and safety within establishments or areas of service delivery.

In many instances it will be necessary to prepare complementary safety policies for the various departments and areas of service delivery. This will allow individual responsibilities at a local level to be described in more detail.

CONTROL

Some method of control needs to be identified to ensure that the decisions taken for the promotion of health and safety are implemented, as planned. Documented safe working procedures are often one of the easiest methods to ensure that correct systems are communicated to staff. Similarly, management exhibiting high personal regard for safety and trying to highlight instances of bad practice as part of their daily routine will allow a safety culture to be developed.

MONITORING AND REVIEWING

A structured scheme for monitoring and reviewing progress within the departments and areas of service delivery are required. A thorough audit of safety standards and practices should be carried out of at least an annual basis. Routine monitoring of more straightforward matters may be conducted daily, weekly, or quarterly as appropriate, so that prompt action can be taken, where necessary. The results of all monitoring and review exercises should then be brought into the planning and prioritization of current safety objectives.

RISK ASSESSMENTS

A further key requirement which underpins all modern safety legislation is the duty to assess risks to health or safety in all work activities. A written record is required, identifying the significant findings of the process, and highlighting any necessary precautions.

HEALTH SURVEILLANCE

Where identified as part of the risk assessment process, employees must be provided with health surveillance.

Normally it is only required when employees routinely work with equipment and substances that have an identified associated health risk. Examples of this would be a joiner who is routinely exposed to wood dust or a grounds person who routinely uses vibrating equipment, such as a hedge cutter.

HEALTH AND SAFETY ASSISTANCE

The Company fulfils its statutory duties by employing qualified Health and Safety Officers to provide a service to all departments and areas of service delivery. Detailed duties of the Health and Safety Team are included in the organization section of this Manual.

However, in most departments and areas of service delivery, it is desirable that an experienced member of staff acts as a coordinator to facilitate the management of health safety more effectively on a day-to-day basis.

GENERAL

Appropriate fire procedures should be made known to all staff, and to any other persons, such as contractors, who may visit or work within Company premises. Moreover, staff should be made aware of those competent persons nominated to implement any evacuations. Separate advice covering this subject is contained in the Fire Logbook.

Similar procedures should be established for any other severe hazards, and staff informed of the nature of the hazards and the steps taken to protect against them. Emergency procedures covering

compressed gas cylinders and/or the accidental release of toxic gases or vapours two examples of procedures that must be established.

Safety should not be allowed entry to restricted areas on the grounds of safety unless adequate precautions are in place.

Arrangements are required to provide all staff (including temporary workers), with 'comprehensible and relevant information' on emergency procedures and those persons nominated to implement them.

Detailed arrangements will be required to disseminate this kind of written information to all staff. Individual safety policies within departments or area of service delivery will provide a convenient means of setting out how this can be achieved.

It may be necessary to provide specific staff, such as security or cleaning staff, with health and safety information in relation to specialist areas in which they may work, such as hazardous areas.

INDUSTRIAL ACTION

When industrial action is proposed by employees whose absence from work would seriously affect the safety, health, or welfare of those using the Company premises, the relevant senior manager should seek advice from the relevant Director immediately to ensure the continued safe use of such establishments or otherwise. Such situations may include:

- Contractors leaving unfinished work on site which presents a safety hazard.
- The withdrawal of services resulting in a reduction in the desired standards of health, safety, or welfare.
- The withdrawal of services resulting in a reduction in the supervision of employees or client

COMPETENCE AND TRAINING

INTRODUCTION

If all employees are to make a meaningful contribution to health and safety, there must be proper arrangements in place to ensure that they are competent. This means more than simply training them. Experience of applying skills and knowledge is another important ingredient and this needs to be gained under adequate supervision. Managers need to be aware of relevant legislation and how to manage health and safety effectively.

Employees are to be provided with adequate health and safety training:

- On recruitment (usually in the form of induction)
- During both routine and non-routine activities
- On exposure to new or increased risks due to the:
- Transfer or change of responsibility
- Introduction of new equipment or a significant change therein
- Introduction of new technology
- Introduction of a new system or work
- Organizational changes

The training is to:

- Be repeated periodically, where appropriate (including refresher training).
- Be adapted to take account of any new or increased risks.
- Take place during working hours.

It is accepted that safety training taking place outside normal working hours should be regarded as an extension of time at work. It is not permitted for employees to be requested to pay for their own health and safety training.

Training Plans

Having completed the initial analysis, an internal procedure will be required to identify outstanding health and safety training needs for the staff currently employed within each department.

The next stage is to feed all the outstanding requirements into a training plan specific to the department and to carry out an evaluation exercise to identify the most important priorities.

Any managers who require help in devising health and safety training plans for their staff should contact the Human Resource Department.

JOINT CONSULATION

INTRODUCTION

The functions of safety representatives are prescribed in the above regulations. The 2007 regulations have extended the rights of consultation to all workers, not just those represented by trade union representatives.

Safety representatives have the function of representing their follow co-workers in consultation with their employer regarding health and safety matters. To this end they entitled to:

- Carry out safety inspections of the workplace at quarterly intervals.
- To receive information from visiting inspectors of relevant Ministries.
- To examine the causes of reportable accidents.

The employer is obliged to allow reasonable time off with pay to enable safety representatives to fulfil their functions and to receive appropriate training.

THE ROLE OF SAFETY REPRESENTATIVES

The functions of safety representatives are detailed below:

- In general, to represent employees in consultations with employers with the aim of helping.
- To promote and develop the health and safety at work of the employees.
- To investigate hazards and dangerous occurrences at the workplace and to examine the cause of accidents.
- To investigate complaints by any employee they represent relating to that employee's health, safety, or welfare at work.
- To make representations to the employer on matters arising from their investigations.
- To make representations to the employer on general matters affecting the health, safety, or welfare at work of the employees at the workplace.

- To carry out inspections.
- To represent employees in consultations at the workplace with inspectors of relevant Ministries.
- To receive information from inspectors.
- To attend meetings of safety committees.

INSPECTIONS

- Safety representatives are legally entitled to inspect the workplace once every three months.
- Arrangements suitable for each workplace need to be devised. A formal programme of regular inspections may be appropriate. An inspection should be arranged to take place at a time mutually convenient to the manager and safety representative.
- Written reports should be made in respect of unsafe or unhealthy conditions, poor working practices or unsatisfactory arrangements for welfare at work. However, minor matters may be reported orally.
- Normally it should be possible for the employer to take appropriate remedial action. When remedial action is not considered appropriate or cannot be taken within to the safety representative.

INFORMATION TO BE MAD AVAILABLE

Employers should make available the information within the employee's knowledge necessary to enable safety representatives to fulfil their functions, and to enable them to play an informed part in promoting health and safety at work.

REPORTING PROCEDURES FOR SAFETY REPRESENTATIVES.

Safety representatives should initially communicate with the manager of the establishment. Matters of concern should be reported to the manager of the relevant department who may be able to take appropriate remedial action. If, after the first investigation, the manager requires further advice or the matter concerns the provision of resources which are outside the control of the department, the matter should be referred to up through the appropriate managerial channels. If remedial action is not considered appropriate or cannot be taken within a reasonable period, the reasons for this should be explained to the safety representative.

If a safety representative is not satisfied with the response of the Company, he may refer the matter to the representative of his/her trade union or professional association.

Safety representatives are entitled to request the advice of relevant Government Ministries, though it is agreed that this should normally only be done after the Company normal channels of communication have been used.

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SAFETY COMMITTEES

If two or more safety representatives request the employer to set up a safety committee, the employer must do so within three months of the request.

Safety committees should:

- Develop safe systems of work and safety procedures.
- Analyses accidents and causes of notifiable occupational diseases.
- Review risk assessments.
- Examine safety audit reports.
- Consider reports submitted by safety representatives.
- Monitor and review the adequacy of health and safety communication and publicity within the workplace.
- Continuously monitor all arrangements for health and safety and revise them whenever necessary.

Mangers and safety representatives should agree who chairs the meetings, how often meetings should be held and what they hope to achieve. It is important that safety committees review health and safety systems. They should not become reporting Centre's for matters that should be dealt with by managers.

RISK ASSESSMENT

INTRODUCTION

Under Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating to the Health and Safety of Employees at Work", it is a statutory requirement to carry out a risk assessment. Written assessments must be completed for all areas of significant risk.

A risk assessment is carried out to identify the risks to the health, safety and welfare of any person arising out of, or in connection with, work or the conduct of their undertaking. It involves identifying the hazards present and evaluating the extent of the risks involved, considering existing precautions and their effectiveness. This information is needed so that decisions on how to manage those risks are made in an informed, rational, and structured manner, and the action taken is proportionate.

Definitions of hazard and risk are as follows:

- A hazard is something with the potential to cause harm (this can include articles, substances, plant or machines, methods of work, the working environment, and other aspects of work organization).
- A risk is the likelihood that harm will arise from that hazard.

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The Company has adopted a corporate format for carrying out and recording general risk assessments.

A suitable and sufficient risk assessments should:

- Identify the hazards and risks arising from or in connection with work. The necessary control measures and the level of detail in a risk assessment should be proportionate to the risk.
- Consider all those people who might be affected by the undertaking, including employees, other workers at the site and members of the public.
- Include only what an employer could reasonably be expected to know; they would not be expected to anticipate risks that were not foreseeable.
- Be appropriate to the nature of the work and should identify the period for which it is likely to remain valid.
- The assessment should cover all parts of the work activity, including those that are not under the immediate supervision of the employer.
- Take account of the non-routine operations, such as maintenance, cleaning operations, loading, and unloading of vehicles, changes in production cycles and emergency response arrangements.
- Learn from the management of incidents, such as interruptions to the work activity, which frequently cause accidents, and consider what procedures should be followed to mitigate the effects of the incident.
- Be systematic in identifying hazards and looking at risks. For example, it may be necessary to look at activities in groups such as machinery, transport, substances, electricity etc, or to divide the work site on a geographical basis.
- Recognize the way in which work is organized and the effects this can have on health.
- Take account of risks to the public.

EVALUATING RISK

As part of the risk assessment process, it is necessary to carry out a risk evaluation of the hazard and risks identified in the context of the activity. The extent of the risk will depend on:

- The likelihood of that harm occurring.
- The potential severity of that harm, such as any resultant injury or adverse health effect.
- The number of people who might be affected by the hazard.

CONTROLLING RISK

Where risks are already controlled in some way, the effectiveness of those controls needs to be considered when assessing the extent of risk that remains. This can be done by:

- Observing the actual practice; this may differ from the written systems of work, in which case the employees concerned, or their safety representatives should be consulted.
- Addressing what happens in the workplace or during the work activity.
- Taking account of existing preventive or precautionary measures; if existing measures are not adequate, consider what more should be done to reduce risk sufficiently.

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FINAL RISK

When considering the measures that are required to reduce the risk, the accepted hierarchy of control measures is as follows:

1. Eliminate the activity if it can be carried out in another way.
2. Reduce the hazard by substituting for something less hazardous.
3. Isolate or segregate by use of physical barriers.
4. Where possible, combat the risks at source by employing engineering controls, enclosure, local exhaust ventilation, adapting the work to suit the individual as regards the design of workplace, the choice of work equipment etc.
5. Apply palliative measures, such as personal protective equipment when all reasonable measures have been taken and are still insufficient to control the risks.

DECIDING IF CONTROL MEASURES ARE ADEQUATE

Deciding if the control measures in place are sufficient depends upon whether the risks highlighted are adequately controlled.

The risk rating initially calculated should be reduced once the control measures are implemented. This second rating should be recorded in the 'final' or 'residual' risk column. This requires that a judgement to be made based on whether or not it would be reasonably practicable to provide further protection taking full account of the balance between the perceived final level of risk and the cost of putting additional measures in place.

The Health and Safety Team can also advise on the suitability of the control measures proposed.

GENERIC ASSESSMENTS

Departments that control a few workplaces where similar activities take place may produce generic risk assessments reflecting the core hazards and risks associated with these activities. Such generic assessments may be applied by employers or managers at each workplace, provided they can:

- Satisfy them that the generic assessments are appropriate to their type of work.
- Adapt the generic to the detail of their own actual work situations, including any extension necessary to cover hazards and risks not referred to in the generic assessment. Guidance for this process is dealt with later in this section covering the review of risk assessments using forms and flowcharts.

RECORDING

The recorded risk assessment should represent an effective statement of hazards and risks that then leads management to take the relevant actions to protect the health, safety, and welfare of anyone who may be affected by the activity. The record should be retrievable for use by management in reviews and for safety representatives or other employee representatives and visiting inspectors.

The significant findings should include:

- A record of the preventive and protective measures in place to control the risks.
- What further action, if any, needs to be taken to reduce risk sufficiently?

It is recommended that an action plan be generated following completion of a risk assessment. Safe working procedures permits to work, method statements, induction material and training needs analysis are typical vehicles which could be generated or revised because of risk assessment.

CONSULTATION

The risk assessment process needs to be practical and take account of the views of employees and their safety representatives who will have practical knowledge to contribute to it. It is imperative that the control measures recorded reflect actual practice.

REVIEW AND REVISION

As risk assessment is a dynamic process manager should review and, where necessary, modify their risk assessments. Forms, flowcharts, actions plan etc covering the review of risk assessments are included later in this document. The employer needs to review the risk assessment if developments suggest that it may no longer be valid (or can be improved). In most cases, it is prudent to plan to review risk assessments at regular intervals. The time between reviews is dependent on the nature of the risks and the degree of change likely in the work activity. Such reviews should form part of standard management practice.

The following list identifies examples where review and revision of risk may be needed:

- As the nature of work changes, the appreciation of hazards and risks may develop.
- Monitoring of the arrangements may reveal near misses or defects in plant or equipment.
- The risk assessment may no longer be valid because, for example, the results of health surveillance have identified the need for additional protection, or there may have been a confirmed case of occupationally induced disease.
- Adverse events such as an accident, ill health or dangerous occurrence may take place even if a suitable and sufficient risk assessment has been made and appropriate preventive and protective measures taken. Such events should be a trigger for reviewing the original assessment.

It is important to communicate the findings of risk assessments and records should be kept demonstrating this. As the number of risk assessments increases it is appropriate to develop an index of assessments to aid with training.

ARRANGEMENTS FOR RISK ASSESSMENTS IN THE COMPANY

To make the completion of risk assessments as easy as possible a number of forms have been devised.

In accordance with current legislation and Company Health and Safety Policy Statement all departments within the Company must devise and implement procedures to ensure the following objectives are achieved:

- Review existing generic & specific risk assessments.
- Identify & generate any new risk assessment as required.
- Develop Action Plans to incorporate findings from assessments.
- Communicate the existence of risk assessments and appropriate findings to all staff.

To achieve the above objectives, the relevant Director is responsible for ensuring suitable and sufficient arrangements are made to fulfil the requirements detailed below:

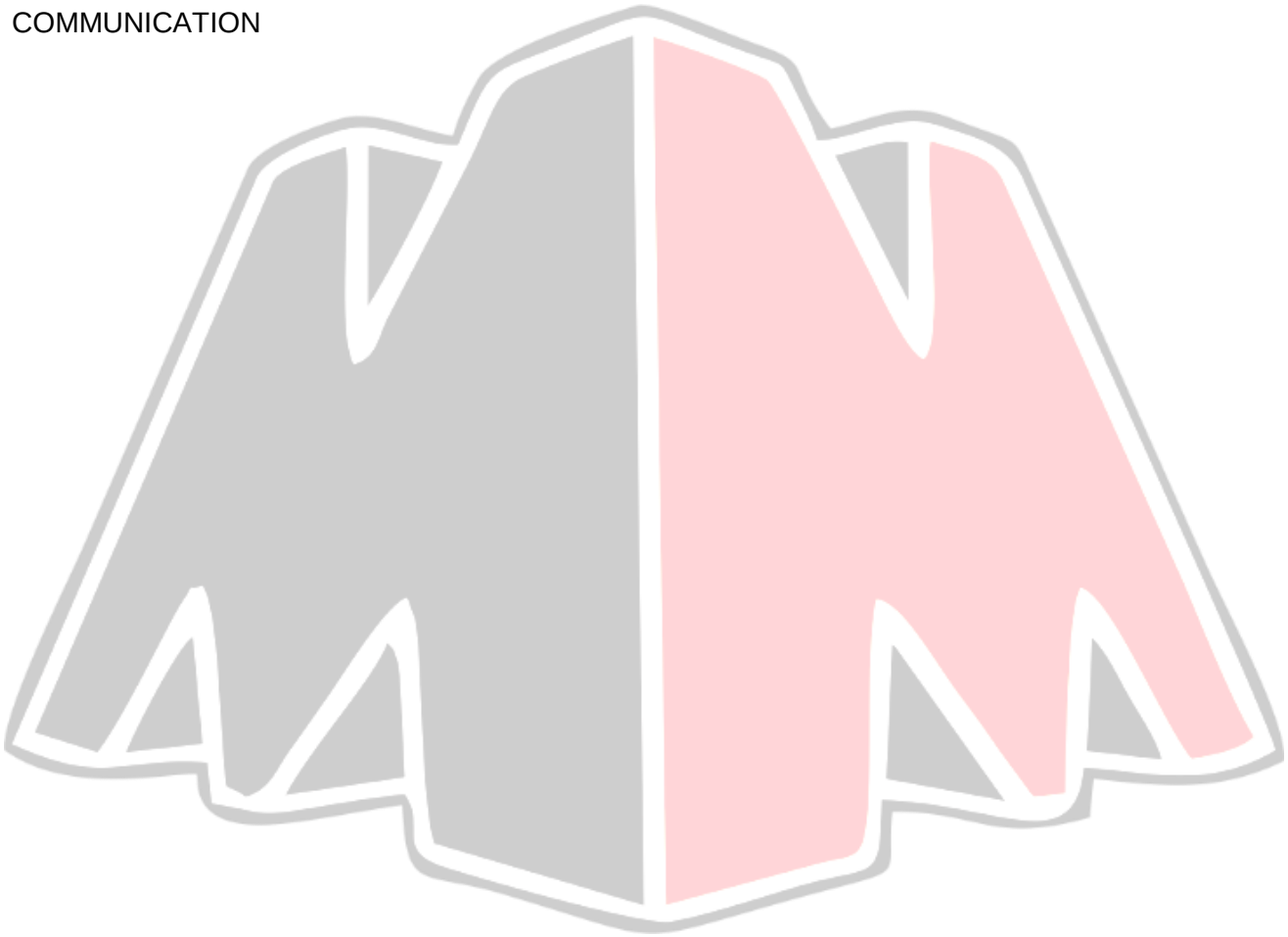
ASSIGN RESPONSIBILITIES

Identify Managers who will assume responsibility for ensuring that risk assessments process is undertaken.

REVIEW EXISTING ASSESSMENTS

Carry out gap analysis and identify new assessments required.

COMMUNICATION



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INTRODUCTION

This Section of the manual sets out the responsibilities and means for ensuring effective communication systems are in place in each department to assist in the promotion of Health and Safety Standards.

THE SAFETY MANUAL

This is the main route for informing managers of new developments in legislation and is written as a general guidance document for both staff and managers. The holders of the safety manual are recorded on a list held within each department. It is the responsibility of the employing Director to ensure that this list is updated as required.

GENERAL CORRESPONDENCE FROM THE SAFETY TEAM

This will be circulated to all staff members on the agreed department circulation lists. It is the responsibility of the employing director to ensure that this list is updated as required.

NOTES FROM SAFETY MEETINGS

Notes from all safety meetings will be communicated through the route indicated on the flow chart below. All staff and safety representatives should be kept fully informed about current safety issues via these mechanisms.

SAFETY BULLETINS

These will be circulated via the agreed department circulation lists, as appropriate.

STANDARD AGENDA

The standard agenda for the health and safety group is as follows:

- Matters arising
- Current issues raised by representatives
- Accidents and incidents
- Inspections and audits
- Claims
- Objectives
- Risk assessments and other documentation
- Training
- New legislation and guidance
- Government Ministry activity
- Any other business
- Date of next meeting

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NOTICE BOARDS

There are designated Safety Notice Boards appropriately placed around Company premises and other buildings. It is the responsibility of the department manager to ensure that these notice boards are serviced and monitor displays. The Health and Safety coordinator for each department/service may audit these to ensure the currency of the information shown.

ACCIDENTS, INCIDENTS AND OCCUPATIONAL DISEASES

INTRODUCTION

It is fundamental to the effective management of safety to have appropriate arrangements in place to deal with accidents and incidents with the potential to cause injury. These arrangements must include adequate follow up procedures for the Company to demonstrate that all steps have been taken to prevent any recurrence. Adoption of such systems is not only good practice; there are specific legal requirements relating to this subject.

Following an accident, it is accepted that because of locality and the remoteness of medical facilities, emergency procedures may vary between areas of work. However, the following points should always be included:

- First aid should be administered by suitably qualified staff.
- If necessary, a request for an ambulance should be made. The person should be made as comfortable as possible until the ambulance arrives. A member of staff should accompany the person in the ambulance. The cost of any return journey made by the member of staff should be borne by the Company.
- In the case of the most serious accidents, the site should be isolated, and nothing should be disturbed until the investigation has taken place. A member of the Company Health and Safety Team should be contacted as a matter of priority. The manager may also need to involve the Police and initiate arrangements to contact the injured persons family.

ACCIDENTS

Following an accident, the Company accident report form should be completed by the manager or nominated officer. This is the only form that should be used for this purpose. If the accident has been reported to a relevant Ministry the notification number must be included in the relevant space on the Company Accident form.

The form should be completed when any person is injured on premises occupied by the Company or because of work activities or undertakings for which the Company is responsible. This includes injuries occurring off the main site.

Accident forms should be sent to the Company Health and Safety Team. A copy of each form must be kept in a secure centralized place within the department for record purposes.

SICKNESS

It is important that any accident or violent incident that occurs at work and results in lost time is logged correctly via the sickness reporting system as an “industrial injury”. This will allow the Company not only to comply with the relevant health and safety requirements, but also their duty to log sickness data.

NEAR MISSES

A near miss is an incident which did not result in injury, but which could, potentially have done so. They should be reported using the Accident form and investigated in the same way as accidents.

DISCLOSURE OF INFORMATION CONTAINED WITHIN ACCIDENT FORMS

When a request for a copy of a completed accident form is made the person requesting the form should be asked to submit this in writing. It is important to advise them of the need to secure the consent of the injured person. It is important that information relating to witnesses (including their names and addresses) must either be removed from the copy or the permission of the latter party obtained.

Where a request is made by a solicitor then it should contain the express consent of the injured party and/or parent, where the injured party is of insufficient age or understanding.

It would also be advisable to request that the solicitors confirm whether they are contemplating legal proceedings in respect of the incident.

INCIDENT INVESTIGATIONS

Once the initial emergency action has been completed an incident investigation should be carried out as soon as possible after an accident, dangerous occurrence or a serious near miss. In general, the Manager should carry this out although in more serious cases a member of the Company Health and Safety Team will also investigate incidents. Managers should be trained in accident investigation techniques and should have completed the Health and Safety Awareness Training or equivalent, which includes development of these skills.

Investigations should be handled sympathetically with the prime concern being the correct identification of cause rather than apportionment of blame.

Managers will need to use their own judgement regarding the seriousness of the accident when deciding upon the level of detail required in the investigation. It should be borne in mind that claims for negligence may be made against the Company and that these may take several years before they are initiated.

Managers will be asked for detailed information regarding incidents and accidents when civil claims are pursued. Detailed accident investigation records drawn up in advance of any claim will allow the Company to have a much stronger defense should civil litigation become an issue.

WHAT SHOULD BE INCLUDED IN THE INVESTIGATION?

The exact circumstances of an accident may often be unclear as individual perceptions may vary. Interviewing witnesses may be necessary and care should be taken to conduct interviews impartially and as soon as possible after the accidents.

The basis for the investigation report will be the information contained on the Accident form. This deals with the facts of the accident. The aim of the accident investigation is to identify the cause of the accident, determine any shortcomings and recommend action to prevent recurrence.

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The most important factors should be critically examined. It is likely that a combination of these will have contributed to the accident. The accident investigation should be carried out objectively and where underlying systems of management are deficient such findings should be documented.

Photographs are useful and best taken immediately following an accident. Photographs should be taken of the site of the accident, equipment being used, floor surfaces and any apparent hazard.

In some instances, it may be necessary to cordon off the site of the accident. Any defective plant or equipment must be retained until a member of the Company Health and Safety Team, or another professional, has inspected it, as appropriate.

Information that has been provided to employees is always very pertinent to an accident investigation. After an accident or near miss it is important to record exactly what information had been given to the person involved and when. The documentation that is likely to be required will relate to the following:

- Information given at induction.
- Written instructions or a record that specific verbal instruction was given.
- Issuance of risk assessments, permits, method statements etc.
- Quality assurance documentation.
- Details of training courses attended.

Investigations should include information such as:

- When and where the accident occurred.
- The identity of any other persons involved or other witnesses.
- A description of the activities being used.
- All other relevant specific factors such as weights, sizes, distances, and substances.
- A description of any personal protective equipment worn.

If a manager takes a statement after an accident then this should be recorded in the first person, either verbatim or paraphrased as appropriate.

RESULT OF THE INVESTIGATION

On completion of the accident investigation recommendations for action should be produced. These will include the following:

- The immediate remedial action taken, for example withdrawal and repair of defective equipment, provision of protective clothing.
- Improvements in systems of work, such as the introduction of a higher standard of monitoring, compliance with written procedures or refresher training for all employees involved with the activity.
- Establishing the validity of the existing risk assessment prior to the accident and recording any alterations required to the risk assessment following the accident. This can trigger an immediate review or be part of a planned formal revision of the relevant risk assessment and its subsequent safe working procedure. Reasonably practicable measures should be included here. However, it should be noted that every accident does not necessarily require that a system of work be re-designed.

COMMUNICATION OF INCIDENT INFORMATION

Discussion of incidents should be a routine agenda item at health and safety committee meetings and at team meetings. Depending upon the seriousness of the accident the details should be communicated through each Department's agreed safety communication mechanisms. It may even be discussed outside the Department if the incident has a Company impact.

In the event of further investigation by the relevant Government Ministry or an insurance company, it is very likely that they will ask how the results of an investigation were disseminated to relevant members of staff.

SAFETY REPRESENTATIVES

Where safety representatives have been appointed by trade unions, they should be given the opportunity to take part in the accident investigation process on request. Details of relevant information must be made available. This would include access to copies of all the forms. If necessary, other documentation may also be provided. The production of other documentation should be discussed with the Company Health and Safety Team prior to release.

STATUTORY REPORTING

Certain specified events arising out of or in connection with work are reportable to either the Ministry of Labour or the Ministry of Health.

In the circumstances specified below the relevant Ministry should be notified:

INJURIES OF EMPLOYEES

- Death of major injury to an employee.
- Lost time accidents resulting in more than seven days off work.

A definitive list of major injuries is given later in this section.

INJURIES TO MEMBERS OF THE PUBLIC

Death or injuries to members of the public or visitors must be reported where they arise out of or in connection with work and result in the injured person being taken from the premises directly to a hospital (this does not necessarily mean by ambulance) for treatment in respect of that injury.

Injuries will not be reportable unless they arise out of, or in connection with, a work activity. This means that an accident must arise from:

- The way the work activity was being carried out, for example it must be attributable to how the work was organized, planned, supervised, or performed.
- The condition of the premises.
- The plant or substances involved in the work activity.

To be reportable, it is not necessary for the person to be hospitalized for 24 hours, merely for them to have been taken from the premises to hospital for treatment.

Accidents to service users who are frail and may be susceptible to falls due to age or arising from a medical condition should be examined carefully.

DANGEROUS OCCURRENCES ARE:

- Collapse, overturning or failure of load bearing parts of lifts and lifting equipment.
- Explosion collapse or bursting of any closed vessel or associated pipe work.
- Failure of any freight container in any of its load bearing parts.
- Plant or equipment encountering overhead power lines.
- Electrical short circuit or overloading causing fire or explosion.
- Any unintentional explosion, misfire, failure, or demolition to the int cause ended collapse,

Projection of material beyond a site boundary or injury caused by explosion.

- Accidental release of a biological agent likely to cause severe human illness.
- Failure of industrial radiography or irradiation equipment to de-energize or return to its safe position after the intended exposure period.
- Malfunction of breathing apparatus while in use or during testing immediately before use.
- Failure or endangering of diving equipment, the trapping of a driver, an explosion near a diver, or an uncontrolled ascent.
- Collapse or partial collapse of a scaffold over five metres high or erected near water where there could be a risk of drowning after a fall.
- Unintended collision of a train with any vehicle.
- Dangerous occurrence at a well (other than a water well)
- Dangerous occurrence at a pipeline.
- A road tanker carrying a dangerous substance overturns, suffers serious damage, catches fire or the substance is released.

MAJOR INJRIES – THES APPLY TO EMPLOYEES ONLY

- Fracture other than to fingers, thumbs, or toes.
- Amputation.
- Dislocation of the shoulder, hip, knee, or spine.
- Loss of sight (temporary or permanent).
- Chemical or hot metal burn to the eye or any penetrating injury to the eye.
- Injury resulting form an electric shock or electrical burn leading to unconsciousness or requiring resuscitation or requiring admittance to hospital for more than 24 hours.
- Any other injury leading to hypothermia, heat-induced illness, or unconsciousness, or requiring resuscitation, or requiring admittance to hospital for more than 24 hours.
- Unconsciousness caused by asphyxia or exposure to harmful substances or biological agents.
- Acute illness requiring medical treatment, or loss of consciousness arising through absorption of any substances by inhalation, ingestion or through the skin.
- Acute illness requiring medical treatment where there is a reason to believe that this resulted from exposure to a biological agent or its toxins or infected material.

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OVER SEVEN DAY INJURIES

The other category of injury that should be reported to the relevant Ministries involves incidents where the injured person is incapacitated for work for more than seven consecutive days, not counting the day of the accident. To capture this information, any days that would not normally have been working days must be counted as 'notional' working days for this purpose. This notification must be completed within 15 working days.

REPORTABLE DISEASES ARE:

- Certain poisonings
- Some skin diseases, such as occupational dermatitis, skin cancer, chrome ulcer, oil folliculitis/acne.
- Lung diseases, including occupational asthma, farmer's lung, pneumoconiosis, asbestosis, mesothelioma.
- Infections, such as: leptospirosis, hepatitis, tuberculosis, anthrax, legionellosis and tetanus
- Other conditions, such as occupational cancer, certain musculoskeletal disorders, decompression illness and hand-arm vibration syndrome.

NOTE: The above lists are not exhaustive.

FIRE SAFETY PROCEDURES

INTRODUCTION

Chapter 3 of Government Notice No. 156 Labour Act, 1992: "Regulations Relating of the Health and Safety of Employees at Work" place a general duty on all employers to make adequate fire safety provision for their employees. The number of fire wardens required is no longer dependent on the number of employees present on site. The regulations require employers to make a formal risk assessment of the fire safety needs and these should be appropriate to the circumstances of each workplace. For this reason, it is best that managers make the assessment of need locally for their own workplace. It is possible that on a complex site where many activities are undertaken simultaneously, more than one risk assessment will be required.

MEANS OF ESCAPE

- Fire doors are provided to prevent the spread of smoke and heat. Keep them shut when not in use and never prop them open or remove self-closing devices.
- Keep corridors and stairways clear of storage and waste material.
- Ensure that final exit doors can be readily opened from the inside without the use of a key.
- Keep areas outside of final exit doors always clear of obstruction.

PORTABLE FIE EXTINGUISHERS

These are intended for fires in the early stages. Ensure that all staff knows where the extinguishers are sited and how to operate them safely. Always ensure that they are inspected and maintained regularly.

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ROUTINE INSPECTION BY USER.

It is recommended that monthly inspections of portable fire extinguishers is carried out to ensure that they are in their proper position and have not been discharged, or have lost pressure (those fitted with pressure indicator), or suffered obvious damage. Any extinguisher not available for use should be replaced.

ANNUAL INSPECTION, SERVICE AND MAINTENANCE BY A COMPETENT PERSON

No guidance is given as this should be done preferably by a representative of the manufacturer, or at least by a competent person following the manufacturer's recommended procedures and using the tools, etc specified therein.

INTERVALS OF DISCHARGE

It is recommended that the intervals of discharge are determined by a representative of the manufacturer, or at least by a competent person following the manufacturer's recommended procedures and using the tool, etc specified therein.

FIRE INSTRUCTIONS FOR STAFF AND GUESTS

Ensure that all staff is aware of their responsibilities in the event of an emergency.

Fire training should be given at regular intervals:

- First Month of Employment: Two instructions periods
- Staff on Night Duties: Three monthly
- Staff on Day Duties: Six Monthly

Ensure that they:

- Know how to raise the alarm.
- Know how to call the fire brigade.
- Know when not to tackle a fire.
- Know how to use a fire extinguisher correctly and safely.
- Know the correct evacuation procedures for the premises.
- Know where the assembly points are.
- Are aware of the contents of the Fire Risk Assessment.
- Are aware that when leaving the building, try to do everything possible to reduce draughts which may fan the fire. It possible close all windows and doors.
- Know who is the responsible person designated to meet the fire appliance when it arrives.
- DO NOT re-enter the building for any reason.
- Be Aware of Common Fire Causes.

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GUESTS

Ensure that guest/ visitors to the premises are aware of the actions to take in the event of an emergency.

ELECTRICAL INSTALLATIONS

- The misuse of electricity is a major cause of fire and is a source of heat.
- Faults should be repaired immediately by a competent electrician.
- Switch off appliances after use.
- Old wiring should be regularly checked and renewed if necessary
- You may need another ring circuit to cope with the increasing number of electrical appliances you want to use.

SMOKING

Smoking is prohibited on the premises (ONLY USE DESIGNATED AREAS)

RUBBISH

Remove rubbish out of the premises and into wheelie bins as quickly and as often as possible.

DANGEROUS GOODS

- All aerosols are either flammable or explosive.
- Keep them all well away from any source of heat.
- All work equipment is suitable for the purpose for which it is used or provided and only used under appropriate conditions.
- Work equipment is properly maintained and, where maintenance logs are kept for high-risk equipment, the log should be kept up to date.
- Work equipment is inspected if its safety is dependent upon the installation conditions or it is likely to be exposed to conditions that could cause deterioration, resulting in dangerous situations.
- People who use work equipment are given adequate information, instruction, and training. This includes written and verbal instructions on the potential risks and precautions when using any type of work equipment. Records of such training must be kept.

Because of the general risk assessment requirement in the Regulations (see Section E1) there is no specific regulation requiring risk assessment. However, it is implicit that risk assessments will be required for compliance with the requirements listed above. A suitable format for the risk assessment for work equipment is included and is available at the end of this section. When purchasing new equipment, this form should be completed prior to purchase.

SUITABILITY OF WORK EQUIPMENT

The Selection of suitable work equipment for tasks and processes makes it possible to eliminate many risks in the workplace. The assessment should consider the safety of equipment in respect of:

- Its initial integrity that it should be installed and located in such a way as to reduce any risk to users and others, such as ensuring there is sufficient space between moving parts of machinery. All forms of energy and substances used or produced by equipment should be considered. For example, it may be necessary to provide additional ventilation in the workplace.
- The place where it will be used some equipment may be unsuitable for the working environment in a particular location because of environment risks, such as wet or flammable atmospheres and confined spaces.
- The purpose for which it will be used - in practice this means that equipment should be used in accordance with the manufacturer's specifications and instructions. Ergonomic risks, such as working heights and reach distances, should be considered.

MAINTENANCE

It is important that work equipment does not deteriorate to the extent that it puts people at risk. The extent and complexity of maintenance can vary substantially from simple visual checks on basic equipment. The frequency at which maintenance activities are carried out should consider the risk to health and safety posed by malfunction or failure. Factors that affect this likelihood could be the intensity of use or the operating environment.

Maintenance regimes – that is, the frequency and format of inspection, testing etc are often determined by the manufacturer. Alternatively, for some specialized equipment the required regime is set out within specific pieces of legislation. For example, cranes, forklift trucks and passenger lifts are covered in the Regulations. In all instances it is the duty of the employer to identify the correct regime and ensure it is implemented.

Maintenance should only be carried out by people who are competent to do the work. The level of knowledge required to demonstrate competence in this area is commensurate with the risk.

MAINTENANCE OPERATIONS

It should be remembered that different maintenance techniques have different benefits, as follows:

- Planned preventative maintenance involves replacing parts and adjusting at pre-set intervals so that risks do not occur because of deterioration or failure of equipment.
- Condition-based maintenance involves monitoring the condition of any safety critical parts and carrying out maintenance, as necessary.
- Breakdown maintenance is only likely to be suitable in situations where failure is not likely to present a significant risk.

Work equipment should be constructed or adapted to ensure that maintenance operations involving a risk to health and safety can be carried out while work equipment is topped. In situations where this not possible, control measures must be in place to reduce risks. In such situation's advice should be sought from the Health and Safety Team.

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INSPECTIONS

After installation or assembly at a new site, work equipment must be subject to a suitable inspection by a competent person. The inspection should include any necessary testing and ensure that the equipment is correctly installed and safe to operate. The installer should usually carry this out. It is essential that managers ensure a commissioning procedure is implemented.

If there is likelihood that the equipment could deteriorate resulting in dangerous situations, inspections should be carried out at suitable intervals. Inspection should also be carried out and each time exceptional circumstances are liable to jeopardize the safety of the equipment, such as overload, collision, or major repair. The frequency of inspection should be determined by a risk assessment to establish the likely periods in which deterioration could present a significant risk. Any manufacturer's guidelines should always be considered. In practice, inspection intervals should be reviewed considering experience.

The extent of the inspection should be proportionate to the risk posed by the equipment. The inspection should always include appropriate testing and checks of safety-related parts, such as limit switches, interlocks, and protection devices (guards). Records of such inspections should be retained. It the equipment is moved to another site; records must be transferred. Records should normally include the type and model of equipment, including identity marks, its normal location, the date and name of the inspector, any faults and actions taken, the name of the person to whom faults were reported and the date and details of remedial actions.

Suitable action should be taken to ensure that any defective equipment is not used. In the case of powered equipment, this is likely to involve an isolation procedure. Other examples of suitable measures might include storing the equipment (which should be labelled as defective) in a secure place until repairs are carried out or the item safely disposed of.

INFORMATION, INSTRUCTION AND TRAINING

All users, supervisors and managers of work equipment must be provided with adequate health and safety information and, where appropriate, specified written instructions relating to the use of such equipment. This can include information provided by manufacturers or suppliers, such as machine manuals, warning labels, training manuals and instruction sheets. These companies are required to provide information to enable the correct installation, safe operation, and maintenance of work equipment. Staff should as or check that they are provided. If may be necessary to produce in-house instructions.

Adequate training covering work methods, any risks likely to arise and precautions to take must be provided. Training needs are likely to be greatest on recruitment. However, training may also be required if there are changes in the system of work or risks to which people are exposed, such as when new technology or equipment is introduced. Refresher training should also be provided, particularly for employees who use equipment infrequently Special consideration should be given to the training and supervision of young persons to whom a greater duty of care is owed.

In general, it is necessary to evaluate the competence of employees to operate the full range of equipment they use and ensure the competence they need to manage and supervise the use of equipment. Training should be used to make up any shortfall in competence to ensure work is carried

out with due regard to health and safety Account should be taken of the circumstances in which the employee works, such as the degree of supervision. Training should take place within working hours.

DANGEROUS PARTS OF MACHINERY AND SPECIFIED HAZARDS

Managers should ensure that risk assessments are used to identify the hazards presented by machinery and that the nature, severity and likelihood of injuries are evaluated. This will help to determine whether the level of risk is acceptable or identify if risk reduction measures are needed.

DANGEROUS PARTS OF MACHINERY

There is an absolute requirement to prevent access to dangerous parts of machinery. It is therefore essential that suitable risk reduction measures are employed to ensure this. The preventative measures listed below are ranked in the order that they should be implemented. The levels of protection are:

- Fixed enclosed guards.
- Other guards and protective devices, such as interlocked guards and pressure mats.
- Protection appliances, such as jigs.
- The provision of information, instruction, training and/or supervision.

SPECIFIC HAZARDS

It is necessary to take steps to prevent exposure to certain specified hazards by means other than the provision of personal protective equipment or by providing information, instruction, training, and supervision. These specified hazards are:

- Any article or substances failing or being ejected from equipment.
- Rupture or disintegration of equipment parts.
- Work equipment catching fire or overheating.
- Unintended or premature discharge of any article, gas, dust, liquid, vapour or substances which are in each case used or stored in the equipment.
- Unintended or premature explosion of the equipment or any article or substance produced, used, or stored in it.

HIGH ARE VERY LOW TEMPERATURES

It is also necessary to take steps to prevent the risk of injury from contact with hot or cold equipment, articles, and substances. Again, engineering methods should also be applied in preference to personal protective equipment or organizational measures, such as warning signs.

EQUIPMENT STABILITY

Risk assessments should also consider the stability of equipment. There are many types of work equipment that might fall over, collapse or overturn unless suitable precautions are taken. Most machines used in a fixed position should be bolted down or fixed securely. Ladders should be set at the correct angle and tied or footed. Some mobile equipment requires the use of stabilizers or outriggers during use to increase its stability. It is essential that this equipment is always used correctly within the limits of its stability. Where balancing or counterbalancing is used on portable equipment the stability of the equipment should be reappraised each time it is repositioned.

Any place where a person uses work equipment should be suitably and sufficiently illuminated. The lighting should be adequate for the task at hand. Special lighting may be required if the task involves the perception of detail.

MARKINGS AND WARNINGS

Wherever appropriate for reasons of health and safety, work equipment must be appropriately marked or incorporate warning signs, systems, or devices. Many examples of such controls are required by specific legislation. Examples include visual or audible warnings, the marking of maximum safe working loads and signs informing users to wear personal protective equipment, such as goggles, while using the equipment in question.

CONTROL SYSTEMS

Control systems for work equipment must be appropriately locate, used, and correctly identified. Examples of control systems include start and stop controls and emergency stops.

It should only be possible to start equipment by using appropriate controls. It should not be possible to re-start the equipment simply by re-setting a protective device. Controls should also be designed and positioned to prevent inadvertent or accidental operation of the equipment.

When risk assessment identifies the need for emergency stops, they should be easily reached and actuated. Common types mushroom-headed buttons, bars, levers, kick plates or pressure sensitive cables.

Where appropriate, equipment should also be provided with suitable means to isolate it from all forms of energy. This is to allow the equipment to be made safe under certain circumstances, such as when maintenance is carried out. The means of isolation should be clearly identifiable and readily accessible. For some equipment, it may be suitable simply to remove a plug. For other equipment, an isolating handle, switch, or valve may need to be locked in the off or closed position to prevent unsafe reconnection.

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LIFTING EQUIPMENT

INTRODUCTION

The regulations aim to reduce risks to people's health and safety from lifting equipment provided by use of work.

The regulations deal with:

- The strength and stability of lifting equipment (including cranes, forklift trucks, chains, and slings).
- The equipment for lifting people (including mobile elevated work platforms and a bed or bath hoist for lifting a resident in a residential home or a passenger lift).
- The equipment for supporting persons (including fall arrest harnesses and climbing harnesses).
- The positioning and installation of lifting equipment.
- The marking of such equipment.

The regulations specify that every employer shall make sure that every lifting operation involving lifting equipment is:

- Properly planned by a competent person.
- Appropriately supervised.
- Carried out in a safe manner.

The regulations detail the requirements for examination and inspection of lifting equipment, the recording and identification of defects found on such equipment and the records and documentation that should be kept for the retrieval of the information.

General requirements of lifting equipment are also contained with the Regulations. These regulations require that lifting equipment is suitable for the tasks to be carried out and that information, instruction and training is provided to staff who use lifting equipment.

The Regulations require a risk assessment to be carried out to identify the nature and level of the risks associated with a lifting operation.

This should include:

- The type of load being lifted, its weight, shape and what is consists of
- The risk of a load falling or striking a person or object and the consequences.
- The risk of the lifting equipment striking a person or some other object and the consequences
- The risk of the lifting equipment failing over while in use and the consequences.

New lifting equipment must conform to relevant product standards and be provided with a test certificate. The equipment should be suitably marked in line with the established arrangements within each department to identify its current test status and be added to each department lifting equipment register.

EXAMINATION AND INSPECTION

The Company will take all reasonably practicable steps to ensure that formal examinations, inspections, and tests of lifting equipment are carried out in accordance with the frequencies recommended within the Regulations.

Furthermore, certificates are required to be issued to confirm that the installation has been inspected and tested in accordance with the aforementioned Standards.

No equipment is to be used for any lifting operations unless it has been tested and marked with a safe working load by a competent person/organization, who must also issue the relevant test certificate.

THOROUGH EXAMINATION BY A COMPETENT PERSON

The “thorough examination” of lifting equipment is divided into four “in service” categories and a “pre-service” category these are:

PRE-SERVICE EXAMINATIONS

Lifting equipment should be subject to a recorded thorough examination by a competent person.

1. Before being put into service for the first time, unless:

    - It has never been used before (in which case it is classed as having had a thorough examination by the manufacturer or supplier and confirmed within the accompanying declaration of conformity); or
    - It has been used by another undertaking but has been supplied with a valid record of thorough examination by a competent person.

2. And, where the safety of the lifting equipment is dependent on installation conditions it must be thoroughly examined:
    - After installation but before being put into service for the first time; and
    - After assembly and before being put into service at a new site or in a new location.

This is to ensure it has been installed correctly and is safe for use.

IN SERVICE EXAMINATIONS

Once in-service lifting equipment should be subject to the following depending on the type, nature and use of the equipment:

- Examination by a competent person every twelve months.
- Examination by a competent person every six months.
- Examination at periods specified by a competent person or organization (this may be the manufacturer, supplier, or insurer).

And, in all cases, after circumstances which may have affected the safety of its use. These include:

- Its involvement in an accident or near miss.
- After significant changes in conditions of use, and
- Long periods out of use.

There is a statutory duty to inspect the following lifting equipment at periods not exceeding twelve months:

- Cranes
- Excavators
- Forklifts
- JCB Load all's (telehandlers)
- HIABS/Lorry Loaders
- Vehicle Ramps and Hoists.
- Any other mechanical lifting equipment used for lifting loads other than passengers.

CONTROL OF SUBSTANCES HAZARDOUS TO HEALTH

INTRODUCTION

The regulations lay down the essential requirements and step-by-step approach to avoid, or otherwise reduce, the exposure to substances hazardous to health.

- Very toxic
- Toxic
- Harmful
- Corrosive
- Sensitizing
- Irritant

(Such substances are labelled with an appropriate sign)

- Substances that have been assigned a workplace exposure limit (WEL) – {see below for definition}
- Substances that have chronic or delayed effects, such as those which are carcinogenic (likely to cause cancer), mutagenic (likely to cause cell mutations) or toxic for reproduction.
- Biological agents who chiefly cover micro-organisms such as bacteria, viruses, fungi and microscopic parasites.

COSHH applies to a wide range of substances used directly in work activities including proprietary cleaning products, solvents, laboratory reagents, adhesives, varnishes, and pesticides. COSHH also applies to substances generated during work activities, such as wood dust and fumes.

Examples of the effects of hazardous substances include:

- Skin irritation or dermatitis because of skin contact.
- Asthma because of developing an allergy to substances used at work.
- Loss of consciousness because of being overcome by toxic fumes.
- Cancer, which may appear long after the exposure to the substances that caused it.
- Infection from bacteria and other micro-organisms.

COSHH places a duty on the employer to undertake a risk assessment to determine what action needs to be taken to prevent employees (and others) from being exposed to hazardous substances used at work. In most cases, this takes the form of an activity-based risk assessments, which is supported by a manufacturer's safety data sheet detailing the risks associated with each hazardous

substance in use. For practical purposes, risk assessments should be undertaken by managers or nominated staff. To comply with the regulations, the following eight steps must be followed:

- Assess the risks.
- Decide what precautions are needed.
- Prevent or adequately control exposure.
- Ensure that control measures are used and maintained.
- Monitor exposure (where appropriate)
- Carry out appropriate health surveillance (where appropriate)
- Prepare plans and procedures to deal with accidents, incidents, and emergencies (where appropriate)
- Ensure that employees are properly informed, trained and supervised.

NOISE

INTRODUCTION

Loud noise could be described as unwanted, distracting, or annoying sound which has the potential to cause physical damage to the body for example, temporary or permanent hearing loss.

HEARING LOSS

People often experience temporary deafness or reduction in hearing sensitivity after leaving as area where high levels of noise are produced. Normally, their hearing recovers within a few hours however, this should not be ignored. These symptoms are an indication that continued exposure to the noise could eventually lead to permanent hearing damage. Permanent hearing damage can also be caused immediately by sudden, extremely loud, explosive noises, for example, from guns or cartridge operated tools.

However, hearing loss is usually gradual through prolonged exposure to noise. Generally, it is only when damage caused by noise combines with general hearing loss due to ageing that people realize how deaf they have become. Signs of this include:

- Family members complaining about the television being too loud.
- Being unable to keep up with conversations in a group, or
- Difficulties when using the telephone.

Eventually everything becomes muffled and people with hearing damage find it difficult to catch sounds like ‘t’, ‘d’ and ‘s’, so they confuse similar words.

In additions, hearing loss is not the only health problem associated with excessive exposure to noise. People may develop tinnitus (ringing, whistling, buzzing, or humming in the ears), a distressing condition which can lead to disturbed sleep.

CONTROL OF VIBRATION AT WORK

INTRODUCTION

Hand-arm vibration (HAV) is a widespread hazard for employees in many industries and occupations. HAV exposure at work can arise from the use of hand-held power tools (such as grinders or hammer drills), hand-guided machinery (such as lawnmowers and plate compactors) and hand-fed machines (such as pedestal grinders). It is now widely accepted that prolonged and regular exposure to vibration can have a detrimental affect on an operator's health. However, the risks from vibration can be effectively controlled and employees can be protected from ill health effects caused by vibration. Therefore, to protect employees, and to comply with the Regulations, the Company will assess the risks from vibration and put in place effective procedures to control them.

EXPOSURE LIMIT VALUES AND ACTION VALUES

For hand-arm vibration

- The daily exposure limit value (ELV) is 5 m/s2 A (8)
- The daily exposure action value (EAV) is 2.5 m/s2 A (8)

For whole-body vibration

- The daily exposure limit value (ELV) is 1.15 m/s2 A (8)
- The daily exposure action value (EAV) is 0.5 m/s2 A (8)

The ELV is the maximum amount of vibration an employee may be exposed to on any single day and must not be exceeded. The EAV is the level of daily exposure to vibration above which Managers are required to take certain actions to reduce their employees' exposure for example, health surveillance, providing tools which produce lower vibration levels of job rotation.

MANUAL HANDLING

INTRODUCTION

The moving and handling of loads has long been recognized as a major source of occupational injury and ill health. This part of the policy is principally concerned with the effective implementation of measures designed to prevent manual handling injuries to employees. It is based on the principle that staff will not undertake manual handling tasks which have the potential to cause harm, unless those tasks have, in the first instances, been risk assessed. Where the risk assessment identifies it to be necessary, prior to an activity being undertaken, and appropriate training shall be provided, together with any handling and personal protective equipment.

MANGEMENT RESPONSIBILITIES

Managers have a responsibility for ensuring the health and safety of employees, which includes the need for safe manual handling. Managers are also responsible for ensuring that suitable risk assessments are completed and are regularly reviewed when the nature of the work changes.

It is the responsibility of line management to ensure that systems are in place to monitor that staff are implementing the principles of safe manual handling. Managers should also ensure that systems of work highlighted in the risk assessments are implemented.

When planning new work areas or refurbishments, consideration should be given to manual handling issues at the earliest stage.

EMPLOYEES RESPONSIBILITIES

Employees have a part to play in providing a safe environment for themselves and their colleagues. They have a duty to implement procedures and practices in accordance with their training and to follow any instructions regarding safe working practices. When using lifting equipment, it is essential that the manufacturer's instructions are followed.

When planning new work areas or refurbishment, consideration should be given to manual handling issues at the earliest stage.

EMPLOYEES RESPONSIBILITIES

Employees have a part to play in providing a safe environment for themselves and their colleagues. They have a duty to implement procedures and practices in accordance with their training and to follow any instructions regarding safe working practices. When using lifting equipment, it is essential that the manufacturer's instructions are followed.

Physical fitness of an individual can be an area of concern. Employees engaged in manual tasks should seek to maintain their own health and fitness at an appropriate level. All employees should report any physical limitations to their line manager.

PRINCIPLES OF CONTROL

The regulations establish a clear hierarchy of measures to control the risk of injury, under which all employers must:

- Avoid hazardous manual handling operations as far as is reasonably practicable – this may be done by redesigning the task to avoid handling the load or by automating or mechanizing the process.
- Make a suitable and sufficient assessment of any hazardous manual handling operation that cannot be avoided.
- Reduce the risk of injury as far as is reasonably practicable. Consideration should be given to the provision of mechanical assistance. Where this is not reasonably practicable then other improvements to the task, the load and the working environment should be explored.
- Monitor steps taken to avoid or reduce manual handling to check they are having the desired affect and, if necessary, seek alternative steps.

STAFF SELECTION

Managers should be aware of the importance of fitness for work and that staff should be capable of carrying out appropriate handling tasks safely.

The Company operates an equal opportunities policy. However, it is still possible that for some jobs, a previous injury or ill health may prevent employment despite other positive attributes that the candidate may have. New members of staff are subject to a satisfactory health assessment and, in the event of appointment, failure to disclose information will render the employee liable to dismissal.

RISK ASSESSMENTS

Staff trained in safe handling techniques should make on the spot assessments before carrying out any manual handling tasks. A written risk assessment needs to be completed for activities which carry a significant risk of manual handling injury. This assessment will require updating whenever any relevant factors change and should be kept on file for reference purposes.

Risk assessments should be carried out by competent people who are familiar with the activity and have been trained in manual handling and risk assessment. Risk assessments for manual handling should consider the four key areas, namely, the task, the load, the individual and the environment. The corporate risk assessment forms for manual handling risk assessment can be found at the end of this section.

WHAT TO CONSIDER WHEN ASSESSING MANUAL HANDLING RISKS

Task

- The nature of the task: find out how much reaching, bending, stooping, stretching, and twisting is involved.
- The position of the load relative to the handler in determining the degree of control and effort required to do the task. If a load must be lifted above head height, for example when accessing high shelves or fixing plasterboard to a ceiling, then the degree of control and effort needed will be greater than the activity were carried out at waist height.
- The frequency and duration of the handling are important in determining the degree of risk. Where there are repetitive lifting operations combined with repeated bending, twisting and reaching over a period of time, the effect of all these tasks added together significantly increases the likelihood of injury.

Load

- The nature of the load: is it heavy, bulky, had to grasp?
- The weight, size, shape, and stability of the load all contribute to the degree of control and effort needed for the activity.
- When moving people there may be a risk of unpredictable movement.

Work Environment

- The nature of the working environment: is it hot, cold, windy, or poorly lit? Are there slopes, uneven ground, or poor access arrangements?
- Constraints on posture (such as fir fighters may experience in confined spaces or home helps working in small rooms) raise the degree of control and effort needed for the task, thereby increasing the risk of injury.
- Poor ground conditions make slips and trips more likely.
- Carrying items on slopes requires greater effort then carrying on the level.
- Manual handling should be done from a scaffold, not from a ladder.
- Placing light materials, such as roofing sheets in windy conditions, makes the manual handling tasks more difficult.

Individual Capability

- Does the job require someone of unusual height or strength? Does the individual have an existing health problem which increases the risk?
- Does the job put at risk someone who might be pregnant or have a disability?

- An individual's age, strength, level of skill and experience will affect how much a person can safely handle.
- Is there a requirement for specific information or training?

Other factors

- Where Personal Protective Equipment is used as a last resort, its implications for the risk of manual handling injury by inhibiting movement should be taken into consideration.

WHAT TO CONSIDER WHEN REDUCING THE RISK OF INJURY

Task

- Adopt an ergonomic approach, where reasonably practicable, by fitting the operation to the individual.
- Use of mechanical aids such as hoists, conveyors, trolleys.
- Adopt industry specific guidance.
- Improve the task layout by ensuring good positioning of storage, considering weight of load and height of storage shelves.
- Reduce the need for twisting, stooping, and stretching.
- Improve the work routine.
- Encourage Team handling
- Provide personal protective equipment.

Load

- Make the load lighter, smaller, easier to grasp, more stable and less damaging to hold.

Work Environment

- Provide sufficient room for the operation to be carried out.
- Maintain surfaces in a good condition, properly drained and free from obstacles.
- Avoid manual handling on different levels.
- Provide a comfortable working environment
- Ensure adequate lighting

Individual Capability

- Be aware that an Individual's capability may be affected by previous or existing health problems.
- Provide abdominal and back support belts, where needed.
- Ensure information, instruction and training is given.

Any recommendations arising from the risk assessments should be developed into local safe working procedures.

In complex cases managers may seek advice from specialist advisors, such as in-house specialists, safety officers, occupational therapists, and physiotherapists, who will assist in making recommendations for the written assessments.

TRAINING

Training is an important aspect in the control of manual handling activities. This enables employees to identify for themselves good and bad movement and to apply the principles of safe handling to all manual handling activities. It promotes good back care by encouraging employees to adopt a lifestyle aimed at preventing postural stress and back care injury.

RECORD KEEPING (TRAINING)

Managers should retain information about members of staff who have received training.

Accurate records are required showing:

- Signed attendance for morning/afternoon sessions.
- Course content supported by literature and materials issued to course participants.
- Records of training with specific equipment and when it is to be used.
- Records of training updates/refresher training.

Most of the training course are competency based which allows a measurement of performance at the end of the training course. A certificate of attendance will be issued on completion of the relevant course.

Manual handling training may be provided by external organizations which deliver training on the Company's behalf and are qualified to appropriate standards.

WORKPLACE HEALTH, SAFETY AND WELFARE

INTRODUCTION

The regulations are such that obligations are placed on not only "employers" such as the Company but also on "any person having control of a workplace."

The regulations aim to ensure that workplaces meet the health, safety and welfare needs of all members of the workforce, including people with disabilities.

WHAT IS A WORKPLACE?

For the purposes of the regulations a workplace can be describe as any non-domestic premises or part of premises (including outdoor places) made available to any person for the purposes of work. Significantly, this also includes any means of access to or egress from the premises, other then a public road.

WHAT DO THE REGULATIONS COVER?

Broadly speaking employers are obliged to maintain appropriate standards in the following areas:

- Maintenance and servicing of the workplace and equipment.
- Ventilation, temperature, and lighting
- Cleanliness
- Workspaces allocation
- Workstation design and arrangements
- Traffic routes and floors
- Falls and falling objects.
- Glazing.
- Doors and gates.
- Travelators and escalators.
- Sanitary and washing facilities.
- Drinking water supply.
- Accommodation for clothing.
- Facilities for changing rest and meals.

Each of these issues is discussed briefly below:

MAINTENANCE AND SERVICING OF THE WORKPLACE AND EQUIPMENT

Workplaces and equipment are to be cleaned and maintained in an efficient state, working order and good repair by competent personnel. If a fault in any equipment is liable to be detrimental to the health and/or safety of the user then a system of maintenance must be devised and implemented. For example, this would apply to emergency lighting and ventilation. The requirement for such a system will be determined through risk assessment.

VENTILATION, TEMPERATURE AND LIGHTING

Ventilation of indoor workplaces must be achieved either naturally or by mechanical means. In many instances windows or other openings will provide sufficient levels of ventilation. Where mechanical means are employed, they must be regularly and properly cleaned, tested, and maintained to avoid contamination.

Lighting should be sufficient to allow people to work and move about safety. If necessary, local lighting should be provided at individual workstations, and at places of risks, such as crossing points on traffic routes. Lighting and light fittings should not create a hazard.

CLEANLINESS

Floor, wall, and ceiling surfaces inside buildings should be of a type that can be kept sufficiently clean. A suitable system for maintaining the cleanliness of these surfaces and any furnishings and fixtures should be adopted. The standard of cleanliness required will depend on the use to which the workplace is put. For example, an area where workers take meals would be expected to be considerably cleaner than an area used for manual tasks.

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Receptacle bins for the temporary storage of waste prior to final disposal should be supplied in suitable quantities. Where the tasks undertaken in a particular area are such that dirt and refuse accumulate on floors or work surfaces this should be cleaned up at least daily. Waste material of any description should not be allowed to accumulate to excessive levels in any workplace.

WORKSPACE ALLOCATION

Workrooms should have enough free space to allow people to move about with ease. The relevant Approved Code of Practice (ACoP) recommends that the volume of the room divided by the number of people working in it should allow at least 11 cubic metres per person. This figure refers to the total volume of the room when empty divided by the number of persons working in it. However, consideration must then be given to the layout, contents, and nature of the work.

WORKSTATION DESIGN AND ARRANGEMENTS

Workstations should be suitable for the people suing them and for the work. People must be able to leave workstations swiftly in an emergency. If work can or must be done when seated, seats that are suitable for the people using them and for the work done should be provided. Seating should give adequate support for the lower back, and footrests should be provided for workers who cannot place their feet flat on the floor.

TRAFFIC ROUTES AND FLOORS

“Traffic route” means a route used by pedestrians, vehicles, or both and includes areas such as stairs, doorways, gates and loading bays.

The segregation of pedestrians and vehicles in the workplace must be organized to ensure safety. There should be sufficient traffic routes, of appropriate width and headroom, to allow people and vehicles to circulate safely with ease.

Floors and traffic routes should be sound and strong enough for the loads place upon them and the traffic expected to use them. The surfaces should not have holes, be uneven or slippery and should be kept free from obstructions.

Any local restrictions should be clearly indicated. Where sharp or blind bends are unavoidable or where vehicles are required to reverse, measures such as one-way systems and visibility mirrors should be considered. Speed limits should be set and displayed at strategic points.

Additional measures need to be taken where pedestrians must cross or share vehicle routes. These may include marking of routes, provision of crossing points, barriers etc.

FALLS AND FALLING OBJECTS

The consequences of falling from height or into dangerous substances can be so serious that a high standard of protection is required. Secure fencing should be provided to prevent people from falling from edges, and objects falling onto people. Where fencing cannot be provided, other measures must be taken to prevent falls.

Where a person might fall two metres or more or might fall less than two metres and risk serious injury (such as falling into a dangerous substances) fencing should be provided at a height of at least

1100mm, and an intermediate guardrail will also be required. Tanks, pits, and other structures should be securely covered or fenced as above.

Specific precautions will be required where there is a danger of falling off or through a roof. These may include fall-arrest systems and crawling boards. Fragile roofs or surfaces must be clearly identified. This is particularly important about the safety of contractors.

Materials and objects need to be stored and stacked in such a way that they are not likely to fall and cause injury.

Storage racking and shelving systems should be of sufficient size and strength to cope with the loads imposed upon them. In circumstances where heavy loading takes place maximum load notices should be displayed at strategic points. Where there is a risk of damage to these systems, for example forklift collision, a formally recorded visual inspection should be undertaken periodically to confirm the continued integrity of the system. Employees should be encouraged to report any damage, however minor, so that its effect on safety may be assessed.

GLAZING

Windows transparent or translucent surfaces in walls, partitions, doors and gates should, where necessary for health and safety reasons, be made of safety material or protected against breakage. In areas where there is danger of people coming into contact with it, it should be marked in order to make its presence apparent. Both these issues can be determined by risk assessment.

Windows, skylights, and ventilators should be such that they can be opened and closed safely. The following precautions should be observed:

- External windows must not open into a traffic route.
- Windows on upper floors must be fitted with restrictors to prevent them from opening so far as to produce a risk of falling from height.
- Viewing panels on doors in thoroughfares and offices etc should not be covered with blinds, curtains, or displays etc.
- Appropriate opening devices, such as poles or pulls, must be provide and used or windows that open at height.
- Damaged windows must be replaced to a high standard.

DOORS AND GATES

Doors and gates must be suitably constructed and fitted with safety devices as appropriate. This means that sliding and powered doors, particularly, must be prevented from falling on or trapping people. Any door that can be pushed open from either side should have a transparent viewing panel. Similarly, conventionally hinged doors which open onto main traffic routes should have a viewing panel.

ESCALATORS

Escalators should function safely, be equipped with any necessary safety device, and be fitted with one or more emergency stop controls which should be easily identifiable and readily accessible.

SANITARY AND WASHING FACILITIES

Suitable and sufficient sanitary conveniences and washing facilities should be provided at readily accessible places. They and the rooms containing them should be kept clean, adequately ventilated and lit.

Washing facilities should have running hot and cold or warm water, soap, clean towels, or other means of drying. Men and Women should have separate facilities unless each facility is in a separate room with a lockable door and is for sole use only.

DRINKING WATER

An adequate supply of means fed, wholesome drinking water should be provided, together with suitable cups. Alternatively, a water supply with an upward drinking jet should be available. Water should only be provided in refillable enclosed containers where it cannot be obtained directly from a mains source. Suitable drinking water is provided at taps within the establishment. However, chilled water is also available. This is maintained via a maintenance agreement with the supplier to maintain standards of cleanliness.

ACCOMMODATION FOR CLOTHING AND FACILITIES FOR CHANGING

Adequate, suitable, and secure space should be provided to store employees' own clothing and special clothing. The facilities should also allow for the drying of clothing, where it is reasonable to do so. Changing facilities, which ensure privacy for the user, should be provided where employees are required to wear specialized clothing.

FACILITIES FOR REST AND TO EAT MEALS

Suitable and sufficient rest facilities should be provided at readily accessible places. Facilities to eat mails should also be provided if the workplace is such that food would otherwise become contaminated.

SAFETY SIGNS

INTRODUCTION

The Regulations require employers to ensure that safety signs are provided (or are in place) and maintained in circumstances where risks to health and safety have not been avoided by other means.

Even when measures have been taken there can often be a 'residual risk' about which employees need to be warned. They also need to be informed of any further measures that may be necessary. Safety signs are needed if they will help to reduce a residual risk which is significant.

PROVISION OF SIGNS

Under the regulations the following types of signs have been included:

- Traditional safety signs, such as Prohibition, Warning, Mandatory and Information signs.
- Acoustic signals, such as warning sirens.
- Hand signals.
- Verbal Communication

It is the intention of the regulations to make all signs easily understandable and communicate the same message in every workplace.

USING SIGNS

All signs should be provided so that they communicate effectively in the given situation and maintained so that they are capable of performing the function for which they are intended.

If a particular hazard is to be identified the prescribed picture should always be used. If no suitable sign exists, then a simple pictogram can be designed in accordance with the principles of the regulations. Signs can be supplemented by text if necessary. This should be done to complement the category of sign used both in colour and text.

MARKING OF OBSTACLES, DANGEROUS LOCATIONS AND TRAFFIC ROUTES

To prevent fall from height or being struck by falling objects secure fencing or barriers will often be required. However, if the risk is low or protection is impractical by other means, marking the dangerous location may be necessary. For example, highlighting the edge of a raised platform could be achieved by using markings or tape consisting of a yellow and black (or red and white) stripe.

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT (PPE)

INTRODUCTION

PPE is a term that covers all equipment that is intended to be worn or held by employees and which protects them against one or more risks to their health and safety. Such equipment includes:

- Safety footwear.
- High visibility waistcoats
- Gloves.
- Protective clothing for adverse weather conditions.
- Safety harnesses.

NOTE: The above list is not exhaustive.

RISK ASSESSMENT

PPE should only be used where the risk cannot be controlled by something equally or more effective. Engineering controls or safe systems of work should always be considered first. This is because PPE protects only the person wearing it, whereas measures controlling the risk at source can protect everyone. Additionally, effective protection is achieved only by suitable PPE, correctly fitted, and maintained and properly used. Furthermore, if more than one item of PPE is being worn, the different items of PPE must be compatible with each other. Lastly, PPE may restrict the wearer to some extent by limiting mobility or visibility, or by requiring additional wight to be carried.

The need for PPE should be identified as part of a risk assessment. This should consider the risks involved and for the circumstances of its use. PPE need not be provided where risks are sufficiently low that they can be considered adequately controlled. The need for voluntary workers and school children to wear PPE should also be assessed.

Whilst most PPE will be provided on a personal basis, some may be used by a number of people. Furthermore, it may be appropriate, to provide a supply of disposable PPE (for example single use coveralls) which can simply be discarded after use.

Once it has been decided that PPE is necessary, suitable items should be selected. These should comply with the appropriate National Standard.

INFORMATION AND TRAINING FOR USERS

Users need to be given information, instruction, and training to enable them to make effective use of the PPE provided. In other words, they should be trained in the correct use of the PPE, how to fit and wear it correctly, and what its limitations are. The extent of the instruction and training will vary with the complexity and performance of the equipment. Users may need refresher training from time to time.

The training should include elements of theory as well as practice in using the equipment and should be carried out in accordance with the recommendations and instructions supplied by the manufacturer.

THEORETICAL TRAINING

Theoretical training needs to take full account of the following:

- An explanation of the risks presents and why PPE is needed.
- The operation, performance, and limitations of the equipment.
- Instructions on the selection, use and storage of PPE related to the intended use.
- Written operating procedures, such as permits to work involving PPE, should be explained.
- Recognizing defects in PPE and arrangements for reporting loss or defects.
- Factors which can affect the protection provided by the PPE, such as:
- Other protective equipment.
- Personal factors
- Working conditions
- Inadequate fitting
- Defects
- Damage and wear

PRACTICAL TRAINING

Practical training needs to take full account of the following:

- Practice in putting on, wearing, and removing the equipment
- Practice and instruction in inspection and, where appropriate, testing of the PPE before use.
- Practice and instruction in the maintenance that can be undertaken by the user, such as cleaning and replacement of certain components.
- Instruction in the safe storage of equipment.

Furthermore, employees must also be given clear instructions in how they can obtain PPE. If disposable PPE is used, it is important that users are told when it should be discarded and replaced.

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DUTIES OF EMPLOYERS

Where protective clothing is issued or its use is required, it must be worn and maintained in accordance with the instructions given by the employer, which should in turn be based on the manufacturer's instructions for use. PPE should be examined before it is put on and should not be worn if it is defective or has not been cleaned. Any defects or loss of protective equipment should be reported to the appropriate manger as soon as possible. Each employee should take reasonable care not to misuse or neglect to use PPE. If employees have any concerns about the serviceability of the PPE they should contact their manager.

MAINTENANCE

A system of maintenance is needed to ensure that the PPE continues to provide the degree of protection for which it was designed. Maintenance includes:

- Cleaning
- Disinfection
- Examination
- Replacement
- Repair and testing

The responsibility for maintenance must be laid down together with the details of the procedures to be followed and their frequency. The maintenance programme will vary with the type of equipment and the use to which it is put. Manufacturers' maintenance schedules and instructions should normally be followed.

ACCOMMODATION

Suitable storage arrangements for PPE should be provided. Accommodation for PPE is needed to ensure that it is protected from contamination, loss or damage by (for example) harmful substances, damp or sunlight. PPE used by peripatetic workers can be stored in suitable containers or areas in the vehicle. The accommodation does not need to be fixed. The user, for example, can keep safety spectacles in a suitable carrying case.

RECORD KEEPING

Managers should keep records. These should include a risk assessment identifying the tasks where PPE is needed. Records should also be kept when PPE is issued and the relevant instructions relating to it should also be issued. These should include the specification of the PPE that has been provided and the date of issue. Management should also keep maintenance

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APPENDIX 1

LIST OF APPOINTED HEALTH & SAFETY PERSONNEL

INTRODUCTION

SAFETY OFFICER (S)

1)	Tel:	Email:
2)	Tel:	Email:

SAFETY REPRESENTATIVES (S)

1)	Tel:	Email:
2)	Tel:	Email:
3)	Tel:	Email:
4)	Tel:	Email:
5)	Tel:	Email:

FIRST AID PERSONNEL

1)	Tel:	Email:
2)	Tel:	Email:
3)	Tel:	Email:
4)	Tel:	Email:
5)	Tel:	Email:

FIRE SAFETY PERSONNEL

1)	Tel:	Email:
2)	Tel:	Email:
3)	Tel:	Email:
4)	Tel:	Email:
5)	Tel:	Email:

SAFETY COMMITTEE

1)	Tel:	Email:
2)	Tel:	Email:
3)	Tel:	Email:
4)	Tel:	Email:
5)	Tel:	Email:

These are updated per site

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PLANT & EQUIPMENT

We have a large fleet of plant available to use comprising of

Description	Type	Serial/VN Number	Quantity
2014 MAN TGM 18.240 Crane Truck 4x4 – 8 TON	Heavy Load Vehicle	AHTH8CB003590536	1
2016 Toyota Hilux GD -6 2.8 4x4	Light Load Vehicle	AAMN640562PX31209	1
2016 Nissan NP300	Light Load Vehicle	AAMN640562PX31209	1
Gedore Tool Box	Hand Tools	-	4
Honda Generator 6KVA 12000W	Power Tool	-	3
HILTI Jack Hammer	Power Tool		2
Major Tech Phase Rotation Meter – 8031F 600V	Testing Equipment	15638903	3
1000V Fluke Clamp- Meter AC/DC	Testing Equipment	16739867	4
Hellermann Tyton T1825 Loop/PSC/Load Tester 1000V	Testing Equipment	1851635	5
Major Tech High Voltage Insulation Tester 10 000V – K3123A	Testing Equipment	#7029346	2

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Hellerman Analog Insulation Tester 100V	Testing Equipment	19234879	2
Major Tech TEL1TLB Polarity Tester 500mA	Testing equipment	1734468	4
Major Tech K4105A Digital Earth Resistance Tester 2000Ω - 2mA	Testing Equipment	1941723	3
14 Ton Hydraulic Tension Stringing Equipment	Overhead Power line Equipment	-	2
Makita Drill Machine 1250W	Power Tool	-	6
Bosch Angle Grinder 720W	Power Tool	-	5
Hilti Hydraulic Crimping	Hand Tool	-	3
Major Tech Measuring Wheel	Hand Tool	-	3
Run Out Pulley's	Overhead Power line Equipment	-	10
Chain Block 2 Ton	Overhead Power line Equipment	-	5
14 Ton Hydraulic Tension Stringing Equipment.	Overhead Power line Equipment	-	2
Cable Drum Stand	Overhead Power line Equipment	-	2
Clamping Shoes	Overhead Power line	-	6 Pairs
Hellermann Tyton Extension Ladder	Hand Tool	-	4

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